hard and long, pounding and crushing him, that their wretched victim is destroyed.' Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*.

. Besides dancing, elephants could also be trained to shoot arrows from a bow and discharge a matchlock, according to Abul Fazl (*The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1).

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston (Murty Classical Library of India, Harvard University Press, 2020).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. The very first accountant that Akbar hired to sort out his finances was the khwajasara, eunuch, Itimad Khan. Itimad Khan was murdered, too, in 1578, having aggravated the ill effects of his 'conceit' by demanding the return of some loans (*The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.

. Ibid.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.